



GOVERNANCE DOCUMENT

Document Retention Policy

International Society of Equity Analysts

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RELATED DOCUMENTS	Privacy Policy

This document forms part of the official governance framework of the International Society of Equity Analysts (ISEA) and should be read together with the related documents listed above.

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1. Purpose

The International Society of Equity Analysts (ISEA) is committed to maintaining accurate, reliable, secure, and accessible records that support effective governance, operational efficiency, regulatory compliance, professional accountability, and the preservation of institutional knowledge.

This Document Retention Policy establishes the principles and requirements governing the creation, classification, retention, storage, protection, retrieval, and disposal of documents and records maintained by ISEA.

The purpose of this Policy is to ensure that ISEA:

- Maintains appropriate records to demonstrate compliance with legal, regulatory, governance, and professional obligations;
- Preserves important historical and professional records;
- Protects confidential and sensitive information;
- Avoids unnecessary retention of information;
- Ensures the orderly destruction of records when no longer required.

This Policy operates consistently with the **Privacy Policy, Complaints Policy, Disciplinary Policy, Whistleblower Policy**, and applicable privacy and recordkeeping obligations.

2. Scope and Application

This Policy applies to all records created, received, maintained, or stored by ISEA, regardless of format or location.

It applies to:

- Governing Council members;
- Committee members;
- Officers;
- Employees;
- Committee members;
- Volunteers;
- Contractors;
- Consultants;
- Chapter representatives;
- Service providers managing ISEA records.

Records covered by this Policy include:

- Physical documents;
- Electronic documents;
- Emails;
- Databases;
- Digital communications;
- Audio and video recordings;
- Meeting materials;
- Professional records;
- Financial records;
- Governance records.

3. Definition of Records

For the purposes of this Policy, a record means any information created, received, or maintained by ISEA that provides evidence of:

- Decisions;
- Transactions;
- Activities;
- Obligations;
- Professional interactions;
- Governance processes.

A record may exist in any medium, including:

- Paper;
- Electronic files;
- Cloud storage;
- Digital platforms;
- Information systems.

4. Recordkeeping Principles

ISEA shall manage records according to the following principles:

4.1 Accuracy and Integrity

Records must be:

- Accurate;
- Complete;
- Reliable;
- Protected against unauthorised alteration.

4.2 Accessibility

Records should be maintained in a manner that allows authorised persons to locate and access them when required.

4.3 Confidentiality

Records containing confidential, personal, professional, or commercially sensitive information must be protected from unauthorised access or disclosure.

4.4 Security

ISEA shall implement appropriate measures to protect records against:

- Loss;
- Damage;
- Cybersecurity threats;
- Unauthorised access;
- Accidental destruction.

4.5 Retention Limitation

ISEA shall retain records only for as long as reasonably necessary having regard to:

- Legal requirements;
- Governance needs;
- Professional obligations;

- Historical importance;
- Operational requirements.

5. Record Ownership and Responsibility

All records created or received in connection with ISEA activities are the property of ISEA unless otherwise determined.

Individuals responsible for creating or managing records must ensure:

- Records are appropriately created;
- Records are stored securely;
- Retention requirements are followed;
- Confidential information is protected.

6. Records Classification

ISEA records shall generally be classified into the following categories:

6.1 Permanent Records

Records of enduring historical, legal, governance, or professional importance.

Examples include:

- Constitution;
- Charter documents;
- Governing Council resolutions;
- Foundational agreements;
- Trademark and intellectual property records;
- Historical membership records;
- Major institutional publications.

Retention period:

Permanent

6.2 Governance Records

Records relating to organisational oversight and decision-making.

Examples include:

- Governing Council meeting agendas;
- Governing Council minutes;
- Committee minutes;
- Governance reports;
- Strategic plans;
- Policy approvals.

Retention period:

Minimum 10 years

6.3 Membership Records

Records relating to members and professional participants.

Examples include:

- Membership applications;
- Membership status records;

- Renewals;
- Professional designation records;
- Member correspondence.

Retention period:

Minimum 7 years after cessation of membership

6.4 Certification Records

Records relating to professional certifications and qualifications.

Examples include:

- Certification applications;
- Examination records;
- Assessment outcomes;
- Certification status;
- Renewal records;
- CPD compliance records.

Retention period:

Minimum 7 years after certification expiry or termination

6.5 Ethics, Complaints and Disciplinary Records

Records relating to professional conduct matters.

Examples include:

- Complaints;
- Investigations;
- Evidence;
- Findings;
- Disciplinary decisions;
- Appeals.

Retention period:

Minimum 7 years after final resolution

Serious matters may be retained permanently where necessary to protect professional integrity.

6.6 Financial Records

Records relating to financial operations.

Examples include:

- Financial statements;
- Invoices;
- Receipts;
- Payment records;
- Tax documentation;
- Audit records.

Retention period:

Minimum 7 years or longer where required by applicable law

6.7 Contracts and Legal Records

Records relating to contractual and legal obligations.

Examples include:

- Agreements;
- Partnership contracts;
- Vendor agreements;
- Legal correspondence;
- Intellectual property agreements.

Retention period:

Minimum 7 years after termination or expiry

6.8 Research and Publications

Records relating to professional content.

Examples include:

- Research reports;
- Articles;
- Publications;
- Educational materials;
- Conference materials.

Retention period:

Minimum 7 years depending on significance

6.9 Event Records

Records relating to conferences, seminars, and professional events.

Examples include:

- Registrations;
- Attendance records;
- Speaker agreements;
- Event materials;
- Feedback records.

Retention period:

Minimum 7 years

6.10 Operational Records

Records supporting daily operations.

Examples include:

- Administrative correspondence;
- Internal reports;
- Project documents;
- Working files.

Retention period:

Minimum 3 years unless otherwise required

7. Digital Records Management

ISEA shall maintain appropriate systems for electronic record management, including:

- Controlled access;

- Backup procedures;
- Version management;
- Appropriate cybersecurity controls;
- Secure storage.

Electronic records shall be retained in formats that remain accessible for the required retention period.

8. Email and Electronic Communications

Emails and electronic communications that constitute official records shall be retained according to their relevant record category.

Examples include:

- Governance decisions;
- Member matters;
- Professional conduct matters;
- Contractual communications;
- Regulatory correspondence.

Routine communications that do not constitute official records may be deleted when no longer required.

9. Confidential and Sensitive Records

Certain records require enhanced protection, including:

- Whistleblower reports;
- Ethics investigations;
- Disciplinary matters;
- Personal information;
- Commercial agreements;
- Governing Council confidential materials.

Access shall be restricted to authorised persons with a legitimate need.

10. Legal Holds

Where ISEA becomes aware of:

- Litigation;
- Regulatory investigation;
- Formal dispute;
- Potential legal proceedings;

ISEA shall suspend normal destruction processes relating to relevant records.

A legal hold remains effective until formally released by an authorised person.

11. Record Disposal

Records may be destroyed when:

- The retention period has expired;
- The record is no longer required;
- No legal hold applies;
- Disposal is authorised.

Disposal methods must ensure confidentiality, including:

- Secure deletion of electronic records;
- Secure destruction of physical documents.

12. Prohibited Disposal Practices

Individuals must not:

- Destroy records subject to investigation;
- Delete records to avoid accountability;
- Remove official records without authority;
- Alter records improperly.

Such conduct may constitute misconduct under ISEA policies.

13. Responsibilities

13.1 Governing Council

The Governing Council is responsible for:

- Approving this Policy;
- Ensuring appropriate governance oversight;
- Maintaining confidence in ISEA's records management framework.

13.2 Audit, Risk and Compliance Committee

The Committee shall:

- Monitor compliance with this Policy;
- Review records management risks;
- Recommend improvements;
- Oversee significant information governance matters.

13.3 Management and Administrators

Responsible persons shall:

- Implement retention requirements;
- Maintain appropriate records;
- Ensure secure storage;
- Coordinate authorised disposal.

13.4 All ISEA Representatives

All persons covered by this Policy must:

- Maintain appropriate records;
- Protect confidential information;
- Follow retention requirements;
- Avoid unauthorised destruction.

14. Privacy Considerations

ISEA shall manage personal information in accordance with the **Privacy Policy**.

Personal information shall not be retained longer than reasonably necessary unless required for:

- Legal obligations;
- Professional verification;

- Historical recordkeeping;
- Protection of ISEA's legitimate interests.

15. Review and Continuous Improvement

The Audit, Risk and Compliance Committee shall periodically review this Policy to ensure alignment with:

- Applicable laws;
- Privacy obligations;
- Governance standards;
- Technology developments;
- Professional organisation best practices.

Amendments shall be submitted to the Governing Council for approval.

16. Effective Date

This Document Retention Policy takes effect on the date approved by the ISEA Governing Council.